



When the Flag Is Clicked

Quick facilitation notes & answer key

Goal

Students meet EVENTS: a script is started by an event, named by an orange hat block ('when green flag clicked'). The key idea is that code waits for its event — until the flag is clicked, the script has not run. Reading the event that triggers a script is the foundation for this subject (parallel scripts and broadcasts come next), and is part of writing/executing code in Grade-2 C3.1.

Ontario curriculum (Grade 2 — C3 Coding)

C3.1 — solve problems and create computational representations of mathematical situations by writing and executing code, including code that involves sequential and concurrent events.

C3.2 — read and alter existing code, including code that involves sequential and concurrent events, and describe how changes to the code affect the outcomes.

Materials

The printed worksheet and a pencil. Optional: a paper 'green flag' card — hold it up to say 'the event happened!' and have a counter (Bit) move on a floor number path 0-5 only when you show the flag.

Run it (about 20 min)

1. I DO: point to the orange hat — 'this is the EVENT block; it starts the script when the green flag is clicked.'
2. WE DO: before clicking, ask 'has Bit moved?' (no — the event has not happened). Then 'click' the flag and run: 0 forward 3 → 3.
3. YOU DO: students answer where Bit lands (3), whether it runs before the event (no), and name the event.
4. Connect: 'Every script needs an event to start it — here it is the green flag.'

Answer key (modelled by the run-gate)

Ex 1 — the flag is clicked, so the event fires and Bit runs: 0 → forward 3 → 3. Bit lands on 3.

Ex 2 — NO, the script has not run before the event; Bit is still on its home number 0.

Ex 3 — the event is 'when green flag clicked' (clicking the green flag).

Event note: the hat block does not move the sprite by itself — it just waits for the event, then the blocks under it run.

Watch for & differentiate

Common error: thinking the script runs as soon as it is written — stress that it waits for its event (the flag click).

Common error: counting the hat block as a move — the orange hat only names the event; the blue blocks under it do the moving.

Simplify: physically withhold the 'flag' card so students see Bit does not move until the event happens.

Extend: ask what other events could start a script (a key press, a tap) — preview of the next sheets.

Success indicator: the child lands Bit on 3 on the flag, says it does not run before the event, and names the green-flag event.